

Phase 1: Brainstorming & Ideation

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Team ID	SWTID-2026-3502	Team Size	5
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1. Introduction

This document records the Brainstorming and Ideation phase of the project **Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer**. The aim of this phase is to understand the problem clearly, look at it from the user's point of view, generate possible solutions and select the one that gives the highest value for the lowest effort.

2. Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

Problem Statement Canvas

Element	Description
I am	A member of the IT procurement team
I'm trying to	Order standard laptops and make sure each one is configured promptly after it arrives
But	The configuration task depends on someone remembering to create and assign it by hand
Because	There is no automation that links an approved laptop request to a task for the hardware team
Which makes me feel	Frustrated, because users wait longer and IT effort is wasted on follow-ups

3. User Story

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

4. Empathy Map

The empathy map captures the two main stakeholders affected by the problem.

Quadrant	Requester (Employee)	IT Procurement / Hardware Team
Says	"When will my laptop be ready?"	"Did anyone create the configuration task?"
Thinks	A standard laptop should be a quick, simple request	Manual tracking is error-prone and wastes time
Does	Raises the request and follows up repeatedly	Checks approved requests and creates tasks manually
Feels	Impatient and unsure of progress	Overloaded, worried about missing a request
Pain points	Long wait, no visibility, delayed start of work	Oversight, rework, uneven task allocation
Gains	Laptop ready soon after arrival	Tasks arrive automatically in the Hardware group queue

5. Brainstorming

Each team member proposed ideas independently, after which the ideas were grouped and discussed together. The ideas considered are listed below.

#	Idea	Pros	Cons
1	Email reminder to the hardware team after each approval	Easy to set up	Still manual; emails get missed
2	Spreadsheet tracker of approved laptop requests	No development needed	Manual updates, no ServiceNow integration
3	Legacy Workflow Editor on the catalog item	Supported in ServiceNow	Older tool, harder to maintain than Flow Designer
4	Flow Designer flow that creates a Catalog Task for the Hardware group	Low-code, native, visual, reusable	Needs correct trigger and catalog item mapping
5	Full custom script with Business Rule	Maximum control	High effort, more risk, harder for others to maintain

6. Idea Prioritisation

Ideas were scored from 1 (low) to 5 (high) on impact, effort (5 means least effort) and maintainability.

Idea	Impact	Effort	Maintainability	Total
1. Email reminder	2	5	2	9
2. Spreadsheet tracker	1	5	1	7
3. Legacy workflow	4	3	3	10
4. Flow Designer flow	5	4	5	14
5. Custom script	5	1	2	8

7. Proposed Solution

Idea 4 was selected. A flow named **Standard Laptop task** will be built in Flow Designer with a Service Catalog trigger. When a standard laptop request is placed and its approval is complete, the flow will use the *Create Catalog Task* action to generate a catalog task with a short description, set the assignment group to **Hardware** and link it to the requested item. The flow will then be attached to the *Standard Laptop* catalog item through its Process Engine tab.

Expected Benefits

- Seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops, with timely configuration.
- Reduced manual intervention and fewer errors in procurement.
- Better resource use through automatic task allocation to the Hardware group.
- Higher overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

8. Outcome of the Phase

The team agreed on the problem definition, the stakeholders and the chosen solution approach, and moved on to detailed requirement analysis.